

Session Tracking technique :
HttpSession + URL rewriting

Why ?

To develop a web app , independent of cookies , for session tracking.

For tracking the clnt (clnt's session) : the only information, WC needs from the clnt browser is JSessionID value. If clnt browser is not sending it using cookie : Servlet/JSP prog can embed the JSessionID info in each outgoing URL .(response: location / href /form action)

What is URL Rewriting : Encoding the URL to embed the Session ID information, so that web app can do the state management even w/o cookies.

forcing client to accept cookies

W.C always 1st chks if JsessionID is coming from cookie, if not ---> then it will chk in URL : if it finds JsessionID from the encoded URL : extracts its value & proceeds in the same manner as earlier.

How to ?

API :

1. For encoding URLs generated by clicking link/buttons(clnt pull I) use

HttpServletResponse method

public String encodeURL(String origURL)

Rets : origURL;JSESSIONID=fjghsjfkhgk12345gjgh

2. For encoding URLs generated by sendRedirect : clnt pull II : use

HttpServletResponse method

public String encodeRedirectURL(String redirectURL)

Rets : redirectURL;JSESSIONID=12345

NOTE : WC suppresses URL encoding if it gets the session id from a cookie(JSESSIONID)

URL rewriting technique is vulnerable to security attack - session fixation(session stealing)

Solution - Replace HTTP by HTTPS , to achieve end to end encryption

OR

Force client to accept the cookies.